Problems of Confusion

1.

While analyzing my communication style, I have discovered that I tend to use a lot of detail. This means that I want to provide everyone with all essential information. While it has a positive effect on clarity, too much detail might ruin the aim of my communication. To improve my communication skills, I can improve the structure of my message by starting from the main purpose of my communication, what I expect from my colleagues, and the term of execution. I also would like to develop my active listening skills to allow other employees ask questions and check if they understood the message I sent.

I also think that I should change my communication style depending on the people I communicate with. Since each member of the team has his own way of processing information, I believe that plain language, images, and written follow-ups can help them in getting the hint. In addition, I believe that communication is a process in which both parties must participate.

To make certain that my team is in sync with my vision, good communication must be consistent, open, and collaborative. I should let people know what I want them to do and why I want them to do it to make them understand the meaning and feel more involved. Having regular meetings, sending written summaries, and organizing feedback sessions can help clarify expectations and eliminate misunderstandings. Paul's words in 1 Corinthians 14:8–9 remind me that communication could produce a better outcome only if it is clear and efficient and thus allows people to act on already received message.

It is important for me to acknowledge that communication is an ongoing process, as evidenced by my experience with communication failures. With this knowledge, I have developed the "communicate, confirm, and follow-up" strategy that will help me build my communication

skills and ensure that my messages are being received as intended. This strategy allows me to avoid miscommunication in the future while showing respect for the different opinions and learning styles of the people that I work with.

2. I have faced communication issue during a software development project in which changing business requirements were discussed with stakeholders but were not communicated systematically with the rest of developers. As a result, each person on the team worked based on different assumptions which led to the rework, doubling of efforts, and delays.

In retrospect, it appears that confusion might have been lessened if there had been one reliable source of project requirements and every change had been communicated to all team members. If there had been regular brief status meetings in which the current expectations could have been checked, then team members would have had opportunities to clarify the meaning of changes in their own words.

This encounter showed me that a good leader should not only pass information in an effective way but also check if people understand it. The next time my team will work on a similar project, I will document the important decisions taken as soon as the meeting is over, write down the requirements, assign responsibilities and make sure everybody understands the information before our project is started.

Another important thing that I will do is make team members summarize the objectives in their own words to avoid misunderstandings in communication. I also learned that accountability is another trait that is required to ensure effective communication. I cannot expect people to receive and interpret my messages the way I intended them to be. I must make sure to follow responsibility for my words and work on ensuring that my message was clear.

References

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AI Usage Disclosure

I implemented ChatGPT in the formatting of the paragraphs as well as in the removal of grammatical mistakes.